



# Cataract Surgery with Macular Degeneration

What patients with macular degeneration need to know about cataract surgery, lens selection, and realistic expectations

Macular degeneration and cataracts are two of the most common causes of vision loss, and many patients have both. **The key challenge is that cataract surgery improves the optics of the eye, but it cannot repair a damaged macula.** With the right lens choice and honest expectations, most patients see meaningful improvement.

## Why AMD Complicates This

### 1 Compromised Central Vision

Macular disease affects fine detail. Cataract surgery can help but won't fix the macula.

### 2 Lens Selection is Critical

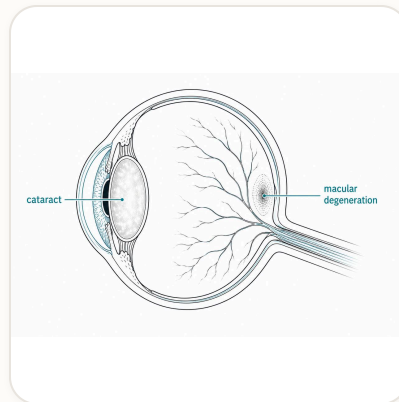
Multifocals are NOT recommended. They reduce contrast, which is already compromised by macular disease.

### 3 Realistic Expectations

Cataract removal helps, but the macula still limits central acuity. Improvement is real but bounded.

### 4 Long-Term Trajectory

Need to consider how macular disease may progress over 10 to 20 years when making surgical decisions today.



Cataract and macular degeneration

## How I Manage These Eyes

### ✓ Thorough Retinal Evaluation

Complete retinal assessment before any surgical planning. Understanding macular status is the first step.

### ✓ OCT Imaging of Macular Status

High-resolution imaging to assess the extent of macular involvement and guide lens selection.

### ✓ Monofocal Lens for Maximum Contrast

Preserving contrast sensitivity is critical when the macula is compromised. Monofocal lenses deliver the sharpest image.

### ✓ Blue-Filtering IOL Option Discussed

Potential benefits for macular protection are reviewed as part of your lens discussion.

### ✓ Both Conditions Managed In-House

My retina fellowship training means I manage both the cataract and the macular disease. Anti-VEGF injections if needed.

## What You Should Expect

Most patients see meaningful improvement after cataract surgery even with macular degeneration. The cataract is an additional layer of blur on top of the macular changes. Removing it helps. But I always set honest expectations about what cataract surgery can and cannot do when the macula is involved.

### Retina Fellowship Advantage

Most cataract surgeons refer macular degeneration to a separate retina specialist. My retina fellowship training means I handle both. Anti-VEGF injections, macular monitoring, and cataract surgery, all from one surgeon who understands your complete eye.

## Questions to Bring to Your Consultation

- Do I have active wet or dry macular degeneration?
- Which lens implant preserves the most contrast?
- How will you monitor my macula after the cataract is removed?
- Will removing the cataract improve my vision given my macular status?
- Will I need injections before or after surgery?
- How does my macular disease affect my lens options?

## Macular Degeneration and Developing Cataracts?

I evaluate both your cataract and your macula, and build a plan with honest expectations and the right lens choice.

**760.340.4700**  
SCHEDULE

[drtokuhara.com](http://drtokuhara.com)  
LEARN MORE